2012 Nissan Sentra 2.0 S

$6,175 · 107,200 miles · Dealer · Ridgecrest, CA

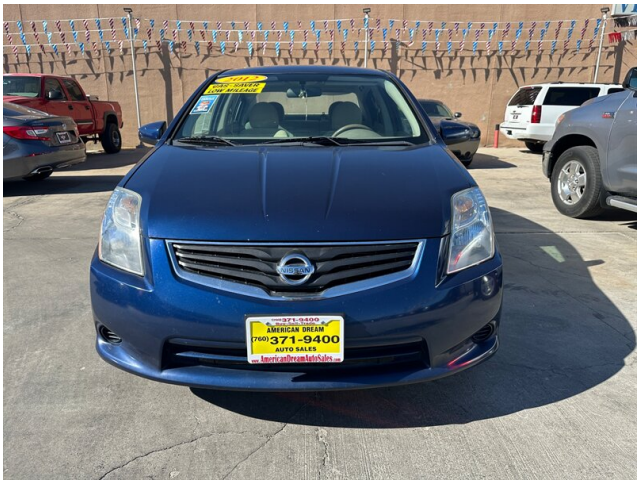
Seller: American Dream Auto Sales (Ed), 239 E Ridgecrest Blvd

Source: AutosToday

Listing: https://www.autostoday.com/cars-for-sale/used-cars/listing/3N1AB6AP4CL772833/2012-nissan-sentra-2-0-s-cvt-ridgecrest-ca

Report generated October 30, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 8 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$7,099	**$531**	**Below average**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	2/5 · 0 recalls · 180 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$6,175.00
Sales tax (9.25%)	$571.19
Dealer doc + filing fees	$125.00
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$40.14
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$65.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$7,099.32
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$2,099.32
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$42.07
Total interest over the loan	$424.64
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$42.07
Insurance (estimate, full)	$135.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 30 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$158.33
Maintenance & repair reserve	$180.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$15.84
Total per month	$531.24

Running costs without the loan: **$489/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$13,265** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Below average (2/5)

Below average. The engine is fine and it gets 27 city / 34 hwy MPG, but 2007-2012 Sentras are known for CVT transmission failures - 'Power train' is the top NHTSA complaint (68 of 180) - and Nissan's extended CVT warranty has expired.

NHTSA data for this model year: 0 recalls · 180 owner complaints (10 involving a crash). Most complaints: Power Train (68), Engine (39), Vehicle Speed Control (22), Unknown Or Other (21), Air Bags (20), Structure (17).

Known issues for this model

• CVT (JF011E) whine, shudder, overheating 'limp mode' or failure - often $3,000-4,000

• Ex-fleet: hard use, basic maintenance

• Engine mount wear

Check on this car before buying

• Ask for CVT fluid change records (none = big risk)

• Long test drive incl. a hill: no whine, slipping or rpm flare

• Inspection with a CVT scan for stored codes

• Dealer handles smog; ask about the 3-day return right (CARS Act)

Notes

Dealer stock #10337R1. $6,175, 107,200 mi, 2.0L, CVT, blue/gray. Clean title, ACCIDENT FREE, fleet history (AutoCheck).

Price 7% above market avg $5,796. Target ~$5,500.

Good gas mileage (27 city), but this generation's CVT is the main risk.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.